



"Making of The Prime Minister",
August 4, 2008

**"The Government
may have won the trust
vote, but certainly not
on moral grounds. It
was a victory where
money played an
important role."**

ROHIT KUMAR,
Mumbai

Man of the Moment

The manner in which Prime Minister Manmohan Singh conducted himself during the trust vote is highly commendable ("Making of the Prime Minister," August 4). An academic scholar and a former bureaucrat, he has slowly transformed into a seasoned politician. He has indeed learnt the tricks of the trade and can survive all odds.
H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
on e-mail

Prime Minister Manmohan Singh is like the proverbial diamond that didn't lose its sparkle despite criticism. His steadfast stance on the nuclear deal will be a benchmark in India's ascendancy in the global arena. Kudos to him and his teammates.
K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
Bangalore

Manmohan Singh has joined P.V. Narasimha Rao

in the "hall of shame". It was but a repeat of history. The UPA Government might have won the trust vote, but Indians have lost faith in democracy. Its victory on the floor of the House carried a price which the UPA had no qualms in paying.
A.K. SHARMA, Chandigarh

With four BJP MPs cross-voting in favour of the UPA, and four others abstaining from voting, the recent trust vote reflected BJP's tainted discipline ("Wilting Lotus", August 4). The emergence of the Left and the BSP has dwarfed the BJP. The new political arithmetic has rightly emboldened the prime minister to take potshots at L.K. Advani, who is nothing but a sitting duck. To put his own house in order, Advani has ample problems to deal with—a divided party, indisciplined members with battered

morale. The motto of the party and its leaders should be "heal thyself".
DR F.S.K. BARAR, Jodhpur

The Leftists won the first round by withdrawing support to the UPA and then by joining hands with Mayawati and the BJP ("In the Boondocks", August 4), to bring down the Government. But unfortunately their opportunistic moves failed to fetch them handsome returns.
RAJNEESH BATRA, Delhi

The genuineness of the 24 MPs (cross-voters) who defied their party whips for the welfare of the country is commendable ("It is 275", August 4). They can serve as an instrument in bringing about a new vibrant India. If these lawmakers can put their vested interests on the backburner for a while and focus just on development and progress of the nation, India will surely

shine in the years to come.
Y. BHASKAR, on e-mail

Holy Order

Setting up a financial corporation to fund the Christians' pilgrimage to Bethlehem is a benevolent move but as Archbishop Marampudi Joji said, it would lead to spiritual groupism ("Divine Proposition", August 4). Politicians may have their expediences and reasoning, but the Christians in Andhra Pradesh must see the larger picture. Money is no doubt a great allure-ment but they must shun such offerings of deception.
RAJ SINHA ROY, on e-mail

It's Just a Deal

Politicians like Amar Singh are nothing but petty dealmakers—a euphemism for a political pimp ("Day of the Dealmaker", July 28). People like him can use any circumstance to